

THE SCIENCE OF GROWING CUSTOMERS

Curriculum Guide

with Daniel Priestley

Your companion to the 16 evergreen lessons: what each lesson teaches, the frameworks inside it, and the shift you'll walk away with. Lesson titles are Daniel's own. Use this guide to navigate the program and revisit any principle or action on demand.

16 lessons · 10 Oversubscribed Principles · 6 Oversubscribed Actions

Part 1 — Oversubscribed Principles

LESSON 1

Only Oversubscribed Businesses Make Profit

You've been told profit comes from creating more value. Daniel dismantles that belief with the first lesson of economics — bananas. 100 bananas and 1,000 buyers means profit; 100 bananas and 10 buyers means loss, no matter how good you are. There are no 'profit gods': airlines run brutal operations for slim margins while Rolex earns 70% by orchestrating waiting lists. You'll shift from supply-side thinking to architecting demand-and-supply tension — starting by naming your official capacity: the number of clients you can truly delight.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- The banana slide — demand-and-supply tension sets the price
- 'There's no profit god' — airlines vs Rolex margins
- Official Capacity — the number of clients you can delight
- Perfectionist → directionalist

"Your job as an entrepreneur is to architect demand and supply tension." — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 2

First Make Your Market, Then Make Your Sales

Stop selling your ten spots — build a market of hundreds who want them. Daniel shows you how to market for signals, not sales, collecting roughly 30 signals of interest per unit of capacity. Through Esther Perel's breakthrough with ultra-high-net-worth couples and Glastonbury's 787,000 registrations for 136,000 tickets, you'll see why 90% of your value depends on who's looking — and how to describe the tension between your capacity and demand until you carry genuine 'with or without you' energy.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- Market for signals, not sales — the 30:1 signals-to-capacity rule
- Esther Perel — 90% of your value depends on who's looking
- ICP — the person with the power to pay the most
- Glastonbury — register-only tickets, gone in 36 minutes

"One of the most powerful things you can do is market for signals, not sales." — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 3

It Takes 11 Interactions, 7 Hours, 4 Locations for People to Be Pre-Sold

People notice you for the first time when they see you for the eleventh time. In this lesson you'll internalise 11-7-4 — 11 interactions, 7 hours, 4 locations — the research-backed journey every buyer travels before they're pre-sold. Daniel shows you why you must tour your message like Bon Jovi toured *Living on a Prayer*, explain what you do simply, and build a content ecosystem the new semantic algorithms can deliver to exactly the right person. Prolific beats perfect.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- 11-7-4 — interactions, hours, locations
- 'You don't write a hit song, you tour a hit song'
- Semantic algorithms — every post finds your perfect person
- Prolific beats perfect — Dolly Parton's 1,000 songs

"You don't write a hit song, you tour a hit song. That's how a hit becomes a hit." — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 4

Decommoditise Through Philosophy & Experience

The moment you describe yourself with features and benefits, you become Googleable — and commodities race to the lowest price. Here you'll craft the philosophy that makes you incomparable, the way Simon Sinek owns 'start with why' and Daniel's client Darren sold boats by talking about reconnecting families. You'll write your own 'If you think it's about X, you've missed the point' statement, then learn how crafted experiences — theatre-venue events, quarterly dinner parties — put you in a category of one.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- Commoditised = easily compared
- Decommoditise through philosophy — the bigger game you're playing
- 'If you think it's about ___, you've missed the point'
- Decommoditise through experience — events that can't be compared

"He didn't talk about boats — he talked about reconnecting families." — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 5

Buying Environments Causes Buying

The same thing in a different environment sells at a different price and velocity. Daniel walks you through the masters — Apple's art-gallery stores staffed by 'geniuses', Rolex's security glass and locked doors — then down to your own Zoom background, where £150 of lighting decides your credibility in a tenth of a second. You'll learn the three intangibles that trigger a buying stampede: logic (the spreadsheet), emotion (the movie in your customer's head), and urgency — used only as a spice.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- Buying environments cause buying — Apple, Rolex, QVC
- The £150 Zoom transformation
- Logic + Emotion + Urgency — urgency is a spice
- 'We don't buy stuff, we buy access to the movie'

"We don't buy stuff. We buy access to the movie." — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 6

People Buy to Solve Problems

People live in the problem, not the solution — so that's where you meet them. Daniel shares how one rewritten headline ('Feeling crabby watching your investments move sideways?') earned him \$90,000 by moving an ad from solution-aware to problem-aware. You'll learn the situation model every buyer constructs — current reality, desired reality, obstacles — and the three priming questions that make people ready to buy. Your homework: map it for your favourite client.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- Meet them at the problem, not the solution
- The situation model — current reality, desired reality, obstacles, path of least resistance
- Three priming questions + 'what have you tried that didn't work?'
- Get a PhD in your customers' problems

"You need to meet them at the problem, not meet them at the solution." — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 7

People Buy What They Want, Not What They Need

Singapore — 80 km/h speed limits, cameras everywhere, million-dollar price tags — has more Ferraris per capita than almost anywhere on Earth. Why? People buy what they want, never what makes sense. Daniel hands you the truck-and-trailer model: values are an unstoppable truck you'll never derail, so hitch your offer to it. You'll confront the fitness-trainer paradox — the people who need you don't value what you sell — and practise linking what you do to freedom, security, adventure, family or status.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- The Singapore Ferrari paradox
- The truck and trailer — link your offer to their values
- The fitness-trainer paradox
- Sell what they want, package in what they need

“If you need to buy the thing, you don't actually want the thing.” — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 8

People Buy What Others Want to Buy, Not What Others Want to Sell

Everything that signals 'I want to sell to you' repels; everything that signals 'others are buying this' attracts. From the too-desperate voicemail, to the ice-cream queue you can't ignore, to Kate Middleton selling out a jacket in three days, Daniel shows you how demand displays do your selling. You'll reframe your copy from 'my program is perfect for CEOs' to 'many of my existing clients are CEOs' — planting the magic subtext: cool, calm, smart people already buy from you.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- Demand displays — queues, reviews, waiting lists
- The copy reframe — 'many of my existing clients are...'
- The magic subtext
- Put your favourite clients in the spotlight

“Everything you do that says other people are buying is what people pay attention to.” — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 9

People Have No Imagination

Half your customer's brain is dedicated to visual processing — and none of it to imagination. Daniel proves it with property developers selling unbuilt towers from glossy CGI, the \$5 million buyer who can't purchase an apartment until it's staged with a couch, and Porsche photoshopping cars onto driveways. You'll turn your intangible work into visual proof: a framework wheel, a before-and-after, a brochure worthy of a car dealership. When they can see the transformation, they sign up on the spot.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- 50% of the brain is visual processing
- Property staging — nobody buys the unstaged apartment
- The wheel vs the list — visualise your method
- Before-and-after as instant proof

"A list? I can't trust someone who has a list. They could have put that in a wheel if they'd thought about it." — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 10

People Are Not Proactive

Your customers will never call you back — the ball is always in your court. In this closing principle, you'll release the belief that sales is icky and see it as the high-end brands do: Apple trains its store teams daily; Rolex runs a bootcamp before staff may speak to a customer. Daniel gives you his 25-year engine — LAPS: Leads, Appointments, Presentations, Sales — plus clear calls to action and the nudge email that can pull six figures from your cold database.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- Homer Simpson customers — it's your job to prompt action
- Clear calls to action everywhere
- Sales is high-end — Apple and Rolex train relentlessly
- LAPS — Leads, Appointments, Presentations, Sales

"The ball is always in your court. It is never in their court." — Daniel Priestley

Part 2 — Oversubscribed Actions

LESSON 11

Campaign Team

All success is a team sport — and in this lesson you stop waiting for milestones and assemble the team that creates them. Daniel maps his four-role campaign team — Key Person of Influence, Head of Growth, Head of Delight, Head of Performance — now built around a central AI system, and shows you where your first recruits actually come from: rebels and misfits, not 'good people'. You leave knowing your role, your first outreach messages, and your Monday-morning meeting rhythm.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- The four roles — KPI, Head of Growth, Head of Delight, Head of Performance
- AI at the centre of the org chart
- 'Good people have jobs' — recruit rebels and misfits
- The 3-to-6 rule — Monday meetings, Friday debriefs, 4–12 people

“Good people have jobs. They're already part of a team. Your job is to find rebels and misfits.” — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 12

Product & Service Ecosystem

One product will never make you money — and in this lesson you discover why. Daniel introduces the Ascending Transaction Model: a Gift that captures attention, a Product for Prospects that earns trust, a Core Offer that drives revenue, and a Product for Clients that delivers recurring profit. Through Gordon Ramsay's cookbooks-to-restaurants empire and Apple's iTunes-to-iPod ladder, you learn to float above your business and design an ecosystem where every product feeds the next.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- The Ascending Transaction Model — Gift → P4P → Core → P4C
- DIY / done-with-you / done-for-you
- Build order: P4P first, Core next, Gifts to scale, P4C last
- The £117,000 add-on — a capped \$39/month membership

“Products and services don't make money. Product and service ecosystems make money.” — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 13

Perfect Repeatable Week

Here Daniel reveals the dirty little secret about success: it's boring, repetitive — and it works. Through Bon Jovi's 803 concerts in six years and his own year-one week (one Sunday ad, one Wednesday workshop, repeated 43 times for \$1.3 million), you learn to engineer a single week that manufactures demand, then crank the handle. You'll master his short-form / long-form / lead-form content engine and the LAPS pipeline, and work backwards from your client target to the exact leads-per-week your machine must generate.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- Bon Jovi — 803 concerts; crank the handle
- Short form daily (Pain · Prize · Problem · News) · long form monthly · lead form quarterly
- Four ways to signal — assessment converts 20–40% vs 2–4% for contact forms
- Reverse-engineer: 30 clients ← 900 leads ← 23 leads a week

“You sharpen in the market, not in your mind.” — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 14

Quarterly Spotlight

Buzz doesn't replace revenue — it lifts it. In this lesson you plan four spotlight campaigns, one per quarter: a guest-speaker event, a sponsored stage, a dinner party, or a relaunch ('if Apple's allowed to do that, why aren't you?'). Daniel's masterstroke is booking a speaker six months out, so you're not buying an hour on stage — you're buying twelve months of brand association, trust transference, and a reason to talk to everyone.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- Spotlights create buzz; repeatable weeks make the sales
- Trust transference — share stages with recognised names
- The quarterly rhythm — announce, engage, deliver, repeat
- Relaunch as new — like Apple's September iPhone

*“You're not paying \$10,000 for an hour on stage. You're paying for 12 months of brand association.”
— Daniel Priestley*

LESSON 15

Annual Big Message

One powerful idea creates an entire year's worth of marketing. In this lesson you choose the big message you'll repeat all year — because if people haven't heard from you in 90 days, their brain archives you. Then Daniel hands you his podcast pyramid: start on tiny shows, become every host's best-performing guest, and climb — exactly how he reached the biggest shows in business. You'll form a PLC group, rehearse your three-minute opening, and tour your message everywhere.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- One big idea, repeated all year
- The 90-day archive rule
- Climb the podcast pyramid — be the best guest at every level
- The PLC group — posts, likes and comments

“If they haven't heard from you in 90 days, their brain starts to archive you.” — Daniel Priestley

LESSON 16

Celebrate & Innovate

Your brain is a dopamine engine — starve it and it stops playing the game. Using Super Mario's coin-by-coin reward loops, Daniel shows you why entrepreneurs who defer every celebration burn out, and how celebrating small wins with your team keeps the whole machine running. Then comes the innovate half: exporting real campaign data into your AI to reveal your true ICP, sharpen your offer, and turn your top-performing posts into ads. Review, celebrate, level up.

KEY FRAMEWORKS

- The Super Mario dopamine loop
- Friday debriefs — celebrate, then 'what could we have done better?'
- Export campaign data → AI segments your real ICP
- Audit your last 30 posts — turn sleepers into ads

“The juice is not worth the squeeze. There is no ginormous pot of gold at the end of the rainbow — celebrate as you go.” — Daniel Priestley